



WAYFARER MARKET CO.

NO LOYALTY CARD. NO ADS. JUST CREW & DISCOVERY.

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Revenue Growth Without Compromising Crew Culture or Brand Identity

1. Executive Summary

Wayfarer Market Co. has built a devoted following on a simple idea: quirky, ever-changing product discovery, no loyalty program, almost no traditional advertising, and a crew-first culture where store staff are treated, and paid, better than almost anywhere else in retail.

Revenue growth has slowed over the past two years as larger chains have copied pieces of our model without our culture behind it. Our board wants a credible path to reaccelerate growth.

One hard line: any recommendation that reads like a generic "cut costs, add loyalty program, run ads" retail playbook will be rejected. We have watched that playbook hollow out culture elsewhere and will not repeat it here.

We are issuing this RFP to identify a consulting partner who can find real, credible growth levers while treating our crew culture and brand identity as design constraints, not obstacles to work around.

2. About Wayfarer Market Co.

Category	Details
Headquarters	West Coast, United States
Ownership	Privately held
Employees ("Crew")	~50,000 across all stores
Store Count	~500 locations
Marketing Approach	No loyalty program, minimal advertising, word-of-mouth and in-store discovery
Culture Notes	Above-market wages/benefits, low turnover, high internal satisfaction scores, strong internal promotion culture

3. Scope of Work

3.1 Revenue Growth Opportunity Assessment

- Assess revenue, traffic, and basket-size drivers across formats and regions
- Benchmark against specialty grocery peers and adjacent categories
- Identify credible growth levers consistent with brand identity

3.2 Format & Assortment Innovation Without Diluting Identity

- Evaluate new formats, categories, or channels that preserve the "treasure hunt" experience
- Explicitly document why generic tactics are inconsistent with the brand, where applicable
- Recommend prioritized growth concepts with rationale tied to brand fit

3.3 Crew Culture & Experience Safeguards During Growth

- Assess risk that growth levers pose to staffing ratios, wages, benefits, and autonomy
- Recommend safeguards to ensure growth doesn't erode the crew experience
- Develop a monitoring approach for culture health alongside revenue growth

4. Required Deliverables

Deliverable	Description
D1 — Growth Opportunity Assessment & Benchmarking	Diagnostic and benchmarked opportunities
D2 — Format & Assortment Innovation Concepts	Prioritized, brand-consistent growth concepts
D3 — Culture & Employee Experience Risk Assessment	Risk analysis with recommended safeguards
D4 — Phased Growth Roadmap	Sequenced roadmap over 18–24 months
D5 — Executive/Board Presentation	Leadership-ready summary and recommended path forward

5. Proposal Requirements

5.1 Executive Summary

Approach overview, credentials, differentiators, timeline and investment.

5.2 Firm Qualifications & Experience

- Specialty retail/grocery growth strategy experience
- Experience protecting employee culture through growth or transformation
- Experience distinguishing brand-authentic growth levers from generic retail playbooks

5.3 Proposed Approach & Methodology

Phase-by-phase methodology, culture-risk framework, stakeholder engagement including store-level crew.

5.4 Team Composition

Proposed team structure, named key personnel, role and time commitment.

5.5 References

Minimum two (2) references from similar growth-strategy engagements; culture-sensitive organizations preferred.

5.6 Proposed Timeline

Start date, duration, milestones, deliverable dates.

5.7 Cost Proposal

Fixed-fee or time-and-materials pricing by phase and deliverable.

6. Proposal Evaluation Criteria

Criterion	Weight & Description
Understanding of Brand & Crew Culture	30% — Culture and identity treated as constraints, not context
Approach & Methodology	25% — Rigor and creativity of growth and culture-risk methodology
Team Qualifications	15% — Relevant retail growth and culture-sensitive experience
Cost & Value	15% — Competitiveness and transparency of pricing
References & Past Performance	15% — Quality and relevance of references

7. Submission Instructions & Timeline

Milestone	Target Date
RFP Issue Date	August 6, 2026
Vendor Q&A Window	August 7–17, 2026
Proposal Due Date	August 27, 2026
Anticipated Award Date	September 17, 2026
Target Engagement Start	November 1, 2026

Proposals must be submitted electronically in PDF format. Maximum length: 50 pages excluding appendices and resumes.

8. Terms & Conditions

- Wayfarer reserves the right to cancel this RFP at any time without obligation
- Submission of a proposal does not guarantee award of a contract

Non-negotiable: Any recommendation that reduces crew wages, benefits, or staffing ratios, or that relies primarily on a loyalty program or mainstream advertising, must be explicitly justified against brand risk or will score lower on Understanding of Brand & Crew Culture.

9. Primary Contact

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Wayfarer Market Co. is a fictional company created for internal testing of a business-development proposal tool. It is not a real business.